

— INSIGHT · COMMISSIONING & OPERATIONS

DATA CENTER COMMISSIONING CHECKLIST: THE QUESTIONS TO SETTLE BEFORE FINAL TESTING

A useful commissioning checklist does not begin with a generic list of tests. It begins with the defined requirements, system boundaries, responsibilities and evidence needed to demonstrate readiness.

1. REQUIREMENTS AND AUTHORITY

- Is the current owner requirement or current design basis available?
- Which criteria govern acceptance?
- Who can approve results, exceptions and retests?
- Are changes traceable to the current basis?

2. SCOPE AND BOUNDARIES

- Which systems and interfaces are included?
- What is explicitly excluded?
- Which party owns prerequisites, test execution, witnessing and documentation?
- How are vendor and construction-package boundaries coordinated?

3. READINESS PREREQUISITES

- What must be installed, inspected and documented before testing begins?
- Are controls, communications and supporting systems ready?
- Are temporary conditions identified?
- Are safety, access and operating controls approved?

4. TEST PLANNING

- Does each activity trace to an approved requirement?
- Are procedures reviewed before execution?
- Are instruments, data sources and acceptance values defined?
- Is the sequence coordinated with other systems and operating constraints?

5. ISSUE MANAGEMENT

- How are deficiencies recorded and assigned?
- What severity or status definitions are used?
- Who decides whether an issue blocks the next step?
- How are corrections, retests and accepted exceptions documented?

6. TURNOVER

- Which results, changes and open items must be delivered?
- Is the final system state clear?
- Does the operating team understand ownership and escalation?
- Are monitoring and maintenance requirements connected to the handoff?

AVOID FALSE COMPLETENESS

A checked box does not prove that the system met its requirement. The record should show what was evaluated, against which basis, under what condition, with what result and who accepted it.

The exact test stages, systems and deliverables vary by project.

WHERE EVOLVE FITS

Commissioning is part of Evolve's documented data-center construction capability. Evolve also remains engaged after turnover through monitoring, maintenance and long-term support. Detailed testing stages and certifications must be defined in the engagement.

EXPLORE COMMISSIONING & TURNOVER

EXPLORE SERVICE & MAINTENANCE

DIRECT ANSWERS

WHAT IS THE MOST IMPORTANT COMMISSIONING DOCUMENT?

The controlling requirements and acceptance basis are essential because test activities and results need something approved to trace back to.

WHEN SHOULD COMMISSIONING RESPONSIBILITIES BE ASSIGNED?

Before testing begins—and early enough to influence design, documentation, construction readiness and turnover.

IS COMMISSIONING COMPLETE WHEN TESTS ARE RUN?

Not necessarily. Issues, retests, accepted exceptions, final records and operating handoff also need closure under the approved process.

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